Buttons

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Buttons let people take an action, such as submitting a form, saving information, or opening a menu. If a button isn't accessible, people can be completely blocked from finishing a task.

Accessible buttons help people who use a keyboard, a screen reader, voice control, or a switch device, as well as people with low vision or motor impairments.

How to support it

- Use a button for actions, and a link to go to a new page
- Use the native `<button>` element, so it works with ‘Tab’, ‘Enter’ and ‘Space’ keys
- Give every button a clear label that describes the action, such as 'Save and continue'
- Give icon-only buttons an accessible name, such as an `aria-label`
- Make sure buttons have a visible focus state, good colour contrast and a large enough tap target
- Avoid disabled buttons, and don't rely on colour alone to show a warning

Useful Links

GOV.UK Design System: Button

NZ Government Web Accessibility Guide: Buttons for keyboard, mouse and touch

W3C WAI: Button examples (ARIA Authoring Practices Guide)